

handed it to Lt. George Pickett, who planted it on the summit of Chapultepec Hill. After the war, Longstreet served at various Texas frontier posts, where he consolidated more friendships that would prove beneficial in the Civil War.

When secession came, he was not ardently supportive of the Southern cause but, believing in the states' rights doctrine, felt compelled to offer his services to Alabama, where his mother still lived and where he knew he would receive a high-ranking appointment as the senior West Point graduate. In 1861, he resigned his U.S. commission.



Storming Chapultepec

Among the victories of the War with Mexico was the Battle of Chapultepec, in which Longstreet saw action and which culminated in the storming of the hilltop castle, shown in this lithograph after a painting by James Walker.

A man of military promise

Called to Richmond, the new Confederate capital, Longstreet was commissioned as a lieutenant colonel in the Confederate States